

Ho‘omaka ka hakuhi i ka kahi e noho ai ka mea pāheona. Makili mai ka mālamalama kakahiaka ma nā puka aniani, a ili nā aka ‘āhie e wehe ai i ke ala o ka ‘ike ‘ōiwi ku‘una mai kekahi hanauna a i kekahi hanauna. Puka mai nā mana‘o kumu i nā kaha ki‘i. No‘ono‘o a‘ela au i nā pilina hohonu i waena o nā hana ‘ōiwi a me nā pilina.

E komo ana i nā kaha ki‘i mua ke au nui me ke au iki o ka mana‘o. Hō‘ike ‘ia nā kaha poepoe i ka ka‘a mau ‘ana o ka ‘ike ‘ōiwi e ho‘oili ‘ia ana i nā hanauna. Ho‘oka‘a ‘ia i kēlā me kēia kaha nā mo‘olelo o nā kūpuna, e kahe ana ko lākou na‘auao i ka pepa. Māhuahua akula nā kaha poepoe, e like me nā pilina pili i loko o nā ‘ohana a me nā kaiāulu.

A hua a‘e nei ka mana‘o, ulu maila a kū mai nā ho‘okolokolo kala. Ho‘ohanohano ka papa wai i ka ‘āina—ka ‘ula wela o ka lepo, ka ma‘o lipolipo o nā mea kanu, a me ka uliuli e ho‘omana‘o ana i ka wai kahe. Koho pono ‘ia kēlā me kēia kala e hō‘ike ana i nā ‘ao‘ao like ‘ole o nā hana ‘ōiwi a me nā kumumea kūlohelohe e kāko‘o ana iā lākou.

Māhuahua akula a hua pono maila. Kui pū ‘ia nā ‘āpana like ‘ole a me nā hō‘ailona e ho‘okīpapa ana i nā papa hohonu o nā hanauna he nui i pili i ka ‘ike ‘ōiwi. Ho‘omālamalama kēlā me kēia papa i nā papa hanauna kupuna o mua, e hō‘ike ana i ke ‘ano mau o ka ‘ike kahiko i loko o nā hana o kēia au nei.

Lilo ia mea pāheona i mea no‘ono‘o kū hohonu, me kēlā me kēia papa e ho‘āla ana i nā mana‘o kūkā ‘ana ma waena o nā kūpuna a me nā mo‘opuna, nā akua a me nā kānaka, a me ka ikaika o nā pilina mo‘omeheu.

‘O ka hopena ka ho‘oponopono ‘ana i ka a pono kaulike ma waena o nā hō‘ailona kahiko a me ka hō‘ike mana‘o ma‘ema‘e o kēia au. Ahuwale maila nā hunahuna ‘ike i ke au o ka manawa, e like me ke ‘ano o ka ‘ike hohonu o nā hana ‘ōiwi e wehewehe ana i loko o nā makahiki o ke a‘o ‘ana.

Hua maila ua ki‘i pāheona nei i ke aka ka “Pili ‘Ohana”—ke ‘ano pili o ke kūlana ‘ōiwi, nā hana, a me nā mana‘o. Kū ke ki‘i ma mua o ke ‘ano he hō‘ailona ‘ike maka wale nō; he hō‘oia ia i ka ikaika mau o nā hana ‘ōiwi a me ko lākou kuleana ko‘iko‘i i ka mālama ‘ana i ke ola pono o ka lāhui.

Ma o nā ‘ano ma‘ema‘e a me ka ho‘onohonoho na‘auao ‘ana, he hō‘ailona nō ia hana e pili ana i ka nani nōhihi o ka lawe ‘ana i ka ‘ike mai kekahi hanauna i kekahi hanauna a me nā pilina hemo ‘ole e pa‘a ai nā ‘ohana a me nā kaiāulu i ka huaka‘i ho‘ōla mau.

The creative process begins in the space where the piece will eventually reside. Morning light filters through the windows, casting gentle shadows that evoke the way ‘ōiwi knowledge passes from one generation to the next. Preliminary ideas emerge through sketches as I contemplate the deep connections between ‘ōiwi practices and bonds.

The initial sketches focus on capturing the essence of movement and flow. Circular forms represent the continuous cycle of ‘ōiwi knowledge being passed down through generations. Each line channels the stories of kūpuna, their wisdom flowing onto the paper. The circular patterns naturally begin to overlap and multiply, much like the interconnected relationships within families and communities.

As the concept develops, color studies begin to take shape. The palette honors ‘āina—warm browns of the earth, deep greens of plants, and blues reminiscent of flowing water. Each color is chosen with intention, representing different aspects of ‘ōiwi practices and the natural elements that support them.

The composition takes shape on a larger scale. Different elements and symbols layer together, building depth that represents the many generations involved in ‘ōiwi knowledge. Each layer reflects the ones before it, showing how ancient knowledge remains visible and relevant in contemporary practices.

The piece becomes a meditative practice, with each layer evoking conversations between grandparents and grandchildren, akua and kānaka, and the strength of cultural bonds.

The final stages involve refining the balance between traditional symbolism and contemporary abstract expression. Subtle details emerge that reveal themselves over time, much like how deeper understanding of ‘ōiwi practices unfolds gradually through years of learning and practice.

The completed piece captures the essence of "Pili 'Ohana"—the interconnected nature of 'ōiwi culture, practices, and perspectives. The artwork stands as more than just a visual representation; it's a testament to the enduring strength of 'ōiwi traditions and their vital role in maintaining community wellbeing.

Through abstract forms and thoughtful composition, it speaks to the beautiful complexity of intergenerational knowledge transfer and the unbreakable bonds that hold families and communities together in the journey of internal healing.